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Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-326-25/26, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 3/10/2026**In Control:** Facilities

Project Approval for the Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies Magnet Multipurpose Athletic Field Upgrades Project

Facilities Services Division

Brief Description:

(Project Approval for the Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies Magnet Multipurpose Athletic Field Upgrades Project) Recommends approval of the \$7,515,769 Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies Magnet (VOCES) Multipurpose Athletic Field Upgrades Project and authorize staff to execute all reasonable instruments for implementation, following adoption of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) Mitigated Negative Declaration (MND).

Action Proposed:

1. Approve the proposed VOCES Multipurpose Athletic Field Upgrades Project (Project). The current Project budget is \$7,515,769.
2. Authorize the Chief Procurement Officer and/or the Chief Facilities Executive and/or their designee(s) to execute all reasonable instruments to implement the proposed Project, including budget modifications and the purchase of equipment and materials.

The Office of Environmental Health and Safety's (OEHS) evaluation of the proposed Project resulted in the preparation of a MND. Pursuant to CEQA Guidelines, staff is requesting the Board of Education (Board) approve the proposed Project so that construction activities can commence at a later date. The proposed action may only be considered after the Board adopts the MND prepared by OEHS in compliance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines for the proposed Project (Board Report No. 284-25/26).

Background:

On December 12, 2023, the Board approved the project definition for the proposed Project to begin the environmental review, design, procurement, and other activities necessary to implement the proposed Project.

The proposed Project is located on a 20.72-acre school campus at 9171 Telfair Avenue in the city of Sun Valley (Board District 6, Region North). The VOCES campus was originally opened in 1960 as Richard E. Byrd Middle School, was then converted to Sun Valley High School in 2009, and subsequently re-established in 2020 as a magnet now known as VOCES, a span school serving grades 6-12. All existing buildings were constructed between 1959 and 2009. As of the 2025-2026 Electronic Capacity Assessment Review, the school served approximately 443 students.

The proposed Project will include new football field lighting, goal posts and scoreboard; installation of new 5-tier portable bleachers; grading, drainage improvements, new natural grass turf regulation-size multipurpose athletic field, and new irrigation system; demolition and removal of existing football goal posts and handball courts; and associated landscape, hardscape, and infrastructure improvements. The proposed Project also

includes accessibility upgrades to ensure compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) requirements, and local, state, and federal regulations.

Expected Outcomes:

Approval of the proposed Project will permit construction activities to be undertaken once the Division of the State Architect (DSA) approval is secured. Construction is anticipated to begin in the second quarter of 2027 and be completed in the second quarter of 2028.

Board Options and Consequences:

Adoption of staff's proposal will permit Los Angeles Unified to proceed with the construction of the proposed Project after DSA approval is secured. If the proposed action is not adopted, staff will be unable to proceed with construction activities. As a result, the School will continue to operate with inadequate athletic facilities. Furthermore, students, staff and the community will not benefit from the significant facilities improvements that will be undertaken as part of the proposed Project.

Policy Implications:

This action helps facilitate the Facilities Services Division Strategic Execution Plan and supports the goals and objectives of the School Upgrade Program (SUP). The proposed action advances Los Angeles Unified's 2022-2026 Strategic Plan, Pillar 4 Operational Effectiveness, Modernizing Infrastructure by upgrading facilities to support the instructional program.

Budget Impact:

The proposed action does not have a budget impact, as the Board previously authorized funding for the proposed Project when it adopted the project definition. The current budget for the proposed Project is \$7,515,769. The proposed Project is funded by Bond Program funds earmarked for school upgrades and reconfigurations to support wellness, health, athletics, learning, and efficiency, and more specifically from amounts allocated for upgrades for athletic facilities in Board District 6.

Student Impact:

The proposed Project will provide new and improved athletic facilities that support physical education programs and student athletic achievement. The proposed Project will also allow the school to practice and/or host games and other school community events, which builds school pride and enhances opportunities to create a positive school culture.

Equity Impact:

Funds are allocated for each Board District based on each Board District's proportionate share of high school enrollment and number of sports teams.

Issues and Analysis:

OEHS evaluated the proposed Project to determine potential impacts on the environment in accordance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines. This evaluation, as documented in the Initial Study (IS), resulted in the preparation of an MND. The MND was circulated for a 30-day public review period from October 9, 2025, to November 10, 2025. The analysis documented in the IS/ND found that the proposed Project would not result in significant environmental impacts as a result of construction or operation of the proposed Project. Pursuant to State CEQA Guidelines, prior to the proposed Project proceeding into construction, the Board must adopt the MND and subsequently must approve the proposed Project.

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Attachments:

None

Submitted:

02/12/26

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,



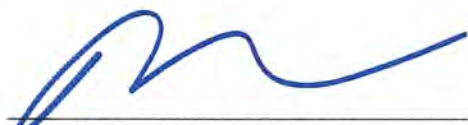
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APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:



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